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Top Skills

Board Governance
Organizational Leadership
Interoperability Standards

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)

Certifications

Building Interactive Applications in
MATLAB
ASU GSV Summit 2016
Apple Teacher
Adobe Certified ColdFusion
Developer
Mastering Final Cut Pro

Honors-Awards

Eduventures "Money Analyst"

Publications

September 29th Interview for
Marketwatch
Focus More on Teaching than
Grading: Try MATLAB Grader
What a Higher Education Institution
Should Know Before Cloud Migration
Use of Electronic Portfolios in STEM
Education
Instructional Design ePortfolio

Patents

Jeff Alderson

Education Technology Product Leader | AI-Enabled Learning |
Systems Architecture | Town Moderator | Higher Ed & Public Sector
Governance

Natick, Massachusetts, United States

Summary

I'm an education technology leader with more than 25 years of experience spanning product strategy, systems architecture, interoperability standards, instructional technology, and public-sector governance. At MathWorks, I lead education product marketing initiatives focused on teaching and learning workflows, including MATLAB Grader and MATLAB Course Designer—platforms used by thousands of instructors and hundreds of thousands of learners worldwide. My current work includes the application of generative and agentic AI to improve instructional design, assessment, and hands-on technical learning experiences. My background combines technical systems leadership with deep experience in higher education, standards development, and organizational process design. Across roles at MathWorks, Eduventures, Houghton Mifflin Harcourt, ConnectEDU, Oracle, and the U.S. Air Force, I have worked at the intersection of technology, education, data interoperability, and large-scale operational systems. Outside of my professional work, I serve as the elected Town Moderator for the Town of Natick, Massachusetts, where I preside over Representative Town Meeting and support transparent, effective civic governance. I have also served on nonprofit and educational boards focused on accessibility, disability inclusion, and educational opportunity. Areas of interest include AI-enabled learning, systems thinking, educational interoperability, civic process modernization, accessibility, and organizational leadership.

Experience

MathWorks

Education Product Marketing
March 2017 - Present (9 years 4 months)
Natick, MA

- * Led launch and growth of MATLAB Grader and MATLAB Course Designer, now used at 3,000+ higher education institutions worldwide.
- * Drive strategy for AI-enabled teaching and assessment workflows supporting technical computing education at global scale.
- * Partner across LMS vendors, standards organizations, education sales, and customer success teams to expand adoption of MATLAB & Simulink in higher education.

Town of Natick

5 years 3 months

Town Moderator

March 2025 - Present (1 year 4 months)

Natick, MA

- * Preside over Natick's 180-member Representative Town Meeting, overseeing legislative procedure, public deliberation, and governance operations.
- * Appoint members to Finance Committee and other public bodies in accordance with town charter and bylaws.
- * Lead procedural modernization and accessibility efforts supporting effective civic participation.

Town Meeting Member

April 2021 - March 2025 (4 years)

Natick, MA

Served as elected representative for Precinct 9 in Natick's 180-member Representative Town Meeting, participating in local legislative decision-making, municipal governance, budgeting, and public policy deliberation.

Waypoint Adventure

Chairman of the Board of Directors

September 2014 - December 2020 (6 years 4 months)

Newton, MA

Served as Chairman of the Board of Directors for Waypoint Adventure, a nonprofit organization focused on empowering individuals with disabilities through adaptive adventure-based programming.

Provided governance and strategic leadership during a period of organizational growth, supporting board operations, nonprofit sustainability, fundraising, community partnerships, and long-term program development. Collaborated with executive leadership and fellow board members to expand organizational

capacity and strengthen the organization's mission of accessibility, inclusion, confidence-building, and personal development through experiential education.

Helped advance initiatives supporting youth and adults with disabilities while promoting broader community awareness around accessibility and inclusive outdoor experiences.

Natick Public Schools

Community Representative, Middle School Council

September 2015 - June 2018 (2 years 10 months)

Natick, MA

The Natick community has consistently made a strong commitment to middle level education--upholding the best practices, systems, and resources available for learners in early adolescence. The Wilson Middle School community rests upon three core values: respect, responsibility and results.

With these values as our foundation, and a strong belief that the school is the hub of the community, we strive to personalize the middle school experience for our students, maximize educational opportunities provided by the school system and the larger community, and partner with families in the learning process.

Alliance of Career Resource Professionals

Honorary Board Member, Board of Directors

2011 - September 2017 (6 years)

Served as Honorary Board Member for the Alliance of Career Resource Professionals (ACRP), supporting industry collaboration, professional development, and standards advancement for career development resources and services.

Contributed to initiatives focused on interoperability, workforce readiness, educational technology trends, and improving access to high-quality career information systems across education and workforce organizations.

Eduventures

Principal Analyst, Enterprise Software

January 2015 - March 2017 (2 years 3 months)

Boston, MA

Principal Analyst covering enterprise software, digital transformation, and emerging technology trends in higher education. Conducted market research

and strategic analysis focused on EdTech, cloud migration, student systems, learning platforms, interoperability, and institutional technology strategy.

Authored industry research reports, advisory publications, market analyses, and thought leadership content for colleges, universities, and education technology providers. Frequently translated complex technology and policy developments into actionable insights for institutional leaders navigating digital transformation and evolving student success initiatives.

Contributed research and commentary on topics including cloud adoption in higher education, educational technology ecosystems, interoperability standards, student data systems, and the evolving role of technology in teaching and learning. Publications and commentary from this work were featured across higher education and industry media outlets.

Houghton Mifflin Harcourt

Lead Architect

October 2013 - January 2015 (1 year 4 months)

Greater Boston Area

Led platform architecture and systems modernization initiatives focused on education data interoperability, scalable integration frameworks, and enterprise application strategy within the P20 education technology landscape.

Developed architecture standards and technical best practices supporting student data systems, interoperability initiatives, and secure information exchange across K-12 and higher education environments. Collaborated with product, engineering, and business stakeholders to align evolving platform capabilities with institutional and market needs.

Contributed to Agile transformation efforts across development teams while evaluating emerging technologies, integration models, and platform strategies supporting long-term product evolution. Worked closely with student information system vendors, electronic records exchange providers, and education institutions to improve interoperability and operational effectiveness across connected education systems.

P20W Education Standards Council (PESC)

Treasurer, Board of Directors

March 2009 - January 2015 (5 years 11 months)

Washington DC-Baltimore Area

Served on the Board of Directors of the P20W Education Standards Council (PESC), including roles as Vice Chairman and Treasurer, helping guide national interoperability initiatives across K-12, higher education, government, and education technology organizations.

Collaborated with institutional leaders, government agencies, nonprofit organizations, and technology providers to advance standards-based data exchange, cross-system interoperability, and secure educational data practices. Participated in cross-agency and cross-vendor working groups focused on PK-20 alignment, student data portability, and improving connectivity across education ecosystems.

Contributed technical and governance expertise to initiatives involving education data standards, digital credentials, student information systems, and large-scale education technology integration efforts in collaboration with organizations including the Data Quality Campaign, SIF Association, CCSSO, SHEEO, and MyData initiatives.

Choice Solutions, Inc.
Infrastructure and Security Architect
June 2013 - October 2013 (5 months)
Greater Boston Area

Collaborated with business and technology leadership to advance platform strategy, systems integration, and modernization initiatives supporting education data ecosystems and enterprise service delivery.

Developed architecture standards and implementation practices for interoperable education technology systems, with a focus on scalability, security, and institutional integration requirements. Participated in Agile transformation initiatives and cross-functional planning efforts to support evolving product and platform strategies.

Worked with student information system vendors, education technology providers, and institutional stakeholders to improve data exchange, systems connectivity, and operational alignment across secondary and postsecondary education environments.

ConnectEDU
9 years 5 months
Chief Solutions Architect

May 2013 - June 2013 (2 months)

Boston, MA

Collaborated with business and technology leadership to advance ConnectEDU's platform strategy, systems integration capabilities, and long-term technology modernization initiatives within the education technology sector.

Developed architecture standards and integration practices supporting scalable student data systems, interoperability, and evolving product platforms. Contributed to Agile transformation efforts across development teams while evaluating technologies and platform approaches aligned with organizational growth and product evolution.

Helped scale the company from startup stage to more than 150 employees while supporting the expansion of college, career, and financial aid planning solutions used by schools and districts nationwide.

Senior Director, Product Innovation

May 2009 - May 2013 (4 years 1 month)

Responsible for the continued innovation of education-related technology products for the largest provider of college, career and financial aid planning solutions nationwide. Product evangelist representing ConnectEDU at various industry events, competitive bidding processes, and non-profit education agencies and foundations; liaison to state and federal gov't projects related to big data. Skilled technologist, able to translate customer requirements into detailed development plans and manage complicated engagements to be delivered on time and on budget.

Director, Pre-Sales Solutions

February 2004 - May 2009 (5 years 4 months)

Led pre-sales activities to schools and districts purchasing ConnectEDU's flagship college and career planning services. Managed proposal responses for competitive bidding scenarios. Designed custom data integration packages for schools wishing to leverage data from their SIS/ERP systems within ConnectEDU's products.

Overboard

Member, Bass

2007 - 2009 (2 years)

[http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Overboard_\(a_cappella\)](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Overboard_(a_cappella))

<http://www.overboardvocals.com>

Vocal Band Aid, Inc.

President

June 2004 - June 2008 (4 years 1 month)

Organized annual charitable events to promote music education in the Greater Boston Area that featured professional vocal bands and acappella groups from the US. Managed all aspects of financial planning and accounting for the event, as well as the activities of the Board of Directors.

Oracle Corporation

Senior Consultant

2003 - 2004 (1 year)

Led systems integration and Java development projects for Oracle's Advanced Programs Group. Enabled the on time and on budget completion of high profile, classified projects for government customers.

Hanscom Air Force Base (Mass.)

Intelligence Surveillance and Reconnaissance Division Systems Chief

July 2001 - May 2003 (1 year 11 months)

Led a team of 30 airmen, officers, contractors and support professionals in the stand up of a combined air operations center (CAOC) at two separate overseas locations during Operations Iraqi Freedom and Enduring Freedom.

NASIC (National Air and Space Intelligence Center)

Electronic Warfare Database Manager

July 1998 - June 2001 (3 years)

Decorated Air Force Officer with experience in large-scale electronic warfare database systems and intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance systems integration projects.

Education

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Master of Education - MEd, Education Policy, Organization & Leadership · (August 2020 - December 2021)

Worcester Polytechnic Institute

B.S., Electrical Computer Engineering · (1994 - June 1998)

Messalonskee High School

· (1990 - 1994)